

Charles Rennie Mackintosh

Scots designer Charles Rennie Mackintosh (1868–1928) mixed art nouveau with Scottish Baronial ideas, the interlacing of Celtic art and design and the elegant simplicity of Japanese forms. He applied his unique linear style of right angles and ornate curves to all aspects of building and interior design. Between 1896 and 1906 he undertook major commissions for private homes, commercial buildings, interior renovations and churches, notably the Glasgow School of Art, of which the central and eastern parts were constructed first, and the second phase eight years later. Overall, the building appears to fuse medieval fortifications with industrial architecture and light, airy art nouveau elements. The Hill House in Helensburgh (opposite, 1902–3) is an extraordinary mixture of art nouveau, Arts and Crafts, Scottish Baronial and Japanese styles. In keeping with the art nouveau style, and all Mackintosh's buildings, the house is asymmetrical: roofs pitch and rise at different angles and heights, chimneys and turrets add to the irregular exterior, while the building itself evolved its shape from the interior plan.

